Chuckles vs. Whispers



A blind taste test study. 25 participants. One clear winner.

Two unlabelled bags were prepared: Bag 1 held Cadbury Whispers, Bag 2 held Woolworths Chuckles. Participants identified contents and recorded a preference without seeing packaging.

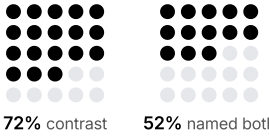
Oct 2026 | AIMS | N = 25 | Double-Blind

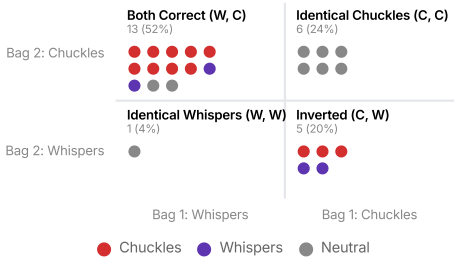
Insight 1

People can taste the difference. They just can't name it.

Sensory contrast is real. Brand identification is not.

72% perceived a difference (18 of 25). Only 52% correctly named both brands (13 of 25). An additional 20% felt the difference but had brands reversed. Identification at chance level (p = 0.043 vs. 50% baseline).





Insight 2

Those who can tell, overwhelmingly choose Chuckles.

Connoisseur conviction: 9 to 2 in favour of Chuckles.

Among 13 correct identifiers, 11 had a preference. Of those, 9 chose Chuckles (81.8%) and 2 chose Whispers. A 4:1 margin, statistically significant (p = 0.033).

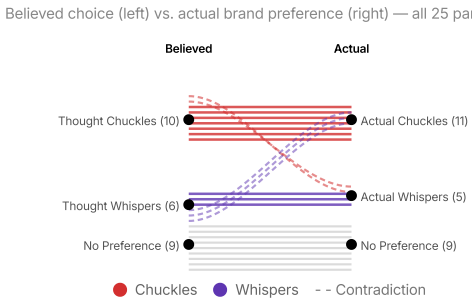


Insight 3

People prefer whichever bag they believe is Chuckles.

Brand expectation shapes taste perception.

Of 16 participants with a preference, 62.5% (10 of 16) chose the bag they believed was Chuckles, regardless of whether they were right. Belief overrides the palate.

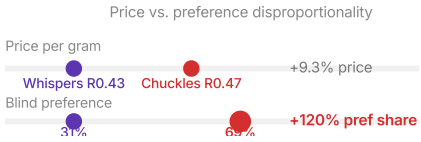


Insight 4

A 9% premium yields twice the preference share.

The Woolworths premium is taste-validated.

Chuckles: R0.47/g vs. Whispers: R0.43/g (+9.3%). In blind testing, Chuckles captured 68.8% of expressed preferences (11 vs. 5). A 120% preference advantage from a modest price difference.

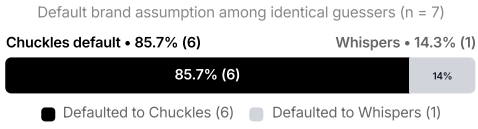


Insight 5

When uncertain, people assume Chuckles.

Chuckles is the mental default brand.

Of 7 participants who perceived both bags as identical, 6 guessed Chuckles both times (85.7%) and only 1 guessed Whispers. All 7 reported no preference, confirming honest responses.

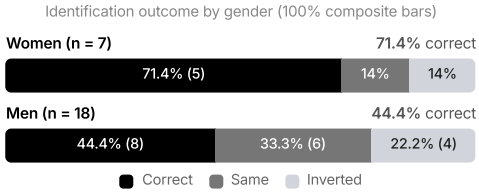


Insight 6

Women identified correctly more often than men.

Gender is the clearest demographic signal.

Women: 71.4% correct (5 of 7). Men: 44.4% correct (8 of 18). Notable difference across a small sample.



Methodology and Statistical Notes

Study Design: Double-blind paired comparison (N = 25). Bag 1: Cadbury Whispers. Bag 2: Woolworths Chuckles. Four-way classification matrix (WW, WC, CW, CC).

Statistical Inference: Exact combinatorial distributions throughout. Sensory discernment via Abbott's chance-correction (P_0 = 0.50; two-tailed p = 0.0433). Preference split among accurate tasters: one-tailed exact binomial (p = 0.0327; 95% CI: 48.2% to 97.7%). Price estimates indicative at time of study. Convenience sample from single organisation.

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